Jack Slaski

Gameplay Developer | Unreal Engine 5 Blueprints and C++

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Professional Profile

Gameplay developer with an MSc in Computer Games Design (Distinction) and four years of Unreal Engine 5 experience, taking systems from first prototype to polished feature. Works mainly in Blueprints, with C++ where performance matters, as in a procedural cave generation tool. Projects include modular weapon crafting, grid inventories, procedural item stats, and Niagara-driven combat feedback. Ran live Garry's Mod servers with 100+ concurrent players from 2020 to 2023, shipping regular updates shaped by community feedback.

Skills

- Unreal Engine 5
- C++ (Unreal Engine)
- Niagara VFX
- UMG and UI Implementation
- Data-Driven Design
- Git Source Control
- Game Feel and Polish
- Blueprint Visual Scripting
- Gameplay Systems Implementation
- Animation Blueprints
- Procedural Generation
- Debugging and Optimisation
- Playtesting and Iteration
- Multidisciplinary Collaboration

Relevant Experience

Founder, Game Designer and Lead Developer | Independent Garry's Mod Communities
June 2020 to February 2023

- Founded three DarkRP servers with 80+ concurrent daily players and co-owned two with 100+.
- Wrote custom Lua inventory and job systems with in-game UI, testing every change in a separate local environment before release.
- Balanced economy and PvP systems using live player data and community feedback, regularly tuning drop rates and weapon stats.
- Led a 50-person team of developers and community staff, generating £13,000 in revenue from in-game purchases.

Relevant Projects

Recoil Works
Gameplay Designer and Developer | MSc Project | Unreal Engine 5 | 2026

- Modular FPS weapon crafting system where interchangeable parts change stats, firing behaviour, ammunition, and projectile effects, built on data tables and structs so new parts slot in without new code.

Feudal Living
Gameplay Designer and Developer | Solo | Unreal Engine 5 | BSc Project | 2025

- Medieval life sim built in eight weeks from a technical design document: decaying needs, skills that change how objects are used, a build mode for buying and placing objects, and an AI that takes over the character when the player goes idle. 2nd place, Gameplay Prototypes, GradEx 2025. Grade: 82%.

Arms & Assets
Systems Designer and Developer | Personal Project | Unreal Engine 5 | 2025 to present

- Multiplayer systems prototype with procedural weapon stats, a grid inventory, upgrading, gem slots, and player trading, plus in-game analytics for engagement and balance.

Cave Generation Tool
Tools Developer | Solo | Unreal Engine 5 C++ | BSc Project

- Wrote a procedural cave generator in UE5 C++ using cellular automata, with seeded generation, room and corridor placement, and designer-facing settings. Grade: 79%.

Wild Magic
UI Implementation and VFX | Team of 18 | 2024

- Implemented the full game UI and created the VFX for a collaborative survivors-like game. Individual grade: 87.5%.

Gerbert Games
Producer and Tech Lead | Team of 7 | 2026

- Built most of the core gameplay, including the tile grid, game mode logic, respawning, dash and grab mechanics, and the HUD, while running sprint planning. Individual grade: 85%.

Leviathan's Gauntlet
Technical Lead | Team of 29 | 2025

- Managed Git and technical integration for a 29-person team, resolving merge conflicts and supporting gameplay development. Individual grade: 87.5%.

Education

MSc Computer Games Design
University of Staffordshire | September 2025 to August 2026
Classification: **Distinction**
Relevant focus: gameplay systems, rapid prototyping, game feel, and technical implementation.

BSc (Hons) Computer Games Development
University of Staffordshire | September 2022 to June 2025
Classification: **First Class Honours**
Relevant focus: gameplay design, Blueprints, team production, and player experience.
Dissertation: Designing a Minimalist UI for Immersive Gameplay (72%)

Additional Qualifications:
A-Levels: BBB | 9 GCSEs, including Mathematics (Grade 8) and English Language (Grade 7)

Leadership and Achievements:
Head Boy | Silcoates School | 2021-2022
Selected by staff and students to organise events, manage prefects, and liaise with the Head and students.
2nd Place, Gameplay Prototypes | Staffordshire University GradEx Awards 2025
Awarded for Feudal Living.

Hobbies and Interests

Sport and Technology
Regularly playing futsal and hockey, and building and upgrading PCs.